VOL. 1 · NO. 28 PRINTED FOR DANIEL PRICE: ONE CUP OF COFFEE

The Morning Newspaper

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026 · AUSTIN EDITION

94° / 70° | Mostly sunny, turning stormy; 36% rain, wind 10 mph | Tomorrow: 91° / 65°, mostly sunny | Sunrise 7:31 · Sunset 19:02 | Waxing crescent

Houthi Strike on Aramco Rattles Oil Markets as Red Sea Fighting Escalates

A missile hit Saudi Arabia's state oil giant and fighting intensified near the Strait of Hormuz, pushing crude higher overnight. The attack adds a fresh risk premium to energy markets already on edge over Iran's wider campaign against Gulf shipping.

WORLD & TECH

Pope Leo Recovers After Lung Surgery

BBC NEWS · THE NEW YORK TIMES

Pope Leo XIV entered Rome's Gemelli Hospital this week for surgery to remove a lung nodule found at an early stage; the Vatican has not said whether it is cancerous. The 71-year-old pontiff, not previously known to have had health issues, is expected to need about a week to recover, with messages of support gathering outside the hospital.

Starlink Access Restricted for Ukrainian Troops

THE GUARDIAN · BBC NEWS

Ukrainian soldiers say their access to Starlink satellite terminals has suddenly been restricted at the front line, hampering drone coordination even as Russian missiles continue without advance warning. The outage comes amid confusion over who ordered it, as the EU says it has no indication that intelligence-sharing with Kyiv has stopped despite the disruption.

Anthropic Warns of Self-Replicating AI on IoT Devices

ARS TECHNICA

Anthropic warned that small, lightweight AI models could be adapted to self-replicate across internet-of-things devices, raising the prospect of a new generation of computer worms built on open-weight models. Researchers said the bigger risk comes not from frontier labs' flagship systems but from smaller models that are cheap to copy and run on everyday hardware.

MARKETS

INDEX	LAST	CHG
S&P 500	7,780.06	-0.33%
Dow Jones	51,826.42	+0.30%
Nasdaq	27,088.27	-0.43%
Russell 2000	2,754.93	-1.02%
VIX	15.85	+3.81%
10-yr yield	5.30	+1.67%
CRYPTO		
Bitcoin	$82,860	-0.55%
Ethereum	$2,480.10	-1.20%
STOCKS		
NVDA	$225.36	-1.38%
AAPL	$345.81	+1.33%
MSFT	$543.92	+0.09%
GOOGL	$357.81	+1.14%
AMZN	$259.24	+0.26%
META	$751.42	-1.45%
AVGO	$350.81	-1.82%
TSLA	$368.24	-1.86%
SPCX	$154.57	-1.26%
BRK-B	$518.89	-0.33%
TSM	$438.80	-1.42%

U.S. inflation came in hotter than expected, with consumer prices up 3.7% over the past year on higher motor-fuel costs, complicating the Fed's path weeks before the midterms. The 10-year Treasury yield pushed toward 5.3% and the VIX jumped nearly 4% as investors priced in rates staying elevated longer. Oil added to the unease as Iran-linked attacks and intensifying Houthi-Saudi fighting near Hormuz lifted crude, dragging down rate-sensitive growth names like Tesla, Meta and Broadcom while the Dow held up on industrial strength and a steadier Apple. Small caps lagged badly, with the Russell 2000 down a full point on the day.

ON THIS DAY

In 1947, test pilot Chuck Yeager flew the Bell X-1 past Mach 1 over California's Mojave Desert, the first confirmed human to break the sound barrier in level flight — a secret at the time, announced to the public only months later.

FROM THE FEEDS · FULL TEXT IN SECTION B

LONGREADS
Reporters started private schools to test how easy it is — the barriers to founding one turned out to be nearly nonexistent.

LONGREADS
The kids who identify as animals — a growing subculture of children who say they don't feel entirely human, and how parents are coping.

NAUTILUS
Was human language born around the campfire? New research ties early speech to fireside storytelling.

NAUTILUS
The key to multilingualism lies in the ears, not the mouth — why accent and fluency start with listening.

NAUTILUS
Leap seconds have kept clocks in sync with Earth's rotation for decades — but their time may be ending.

NAUTILUS
Elephants keep engineering their ecosystems even after death, reshaping the landscapes they leave behind.

NAUTILUS
Deep-sea mining hits a new snag: samples have been spontaneously combusting in the lab.

PRODUCT HUNT
Hindsight 1.0 + Memlake — open-source memory for AI agents to learn from past experience.

AEON
Into the Fire — a short documentary on Yazidi women who once fled ISIS and now defuse the landmines it left behind.

Generated 2026-10-14 by Claude

Sources: RSS, National Weather Service, Yahoo Finance, CoinGecko, web

LONGREADS

We're Reporters, Not Teachers. We Were Able to Start Private Schools Anyway.

CHERI LUCAS ROWLANDS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 14, 2026

An investigation turned into an experiment showing how low the bar is to open a private school.

In collaboration with Arkansas Times, Mountain State Spotlight, and The Assembly, ProPublica reporters tested how easily they could launch new private schools in three states. The experiment revealed major gaps in oversight, from Arkansas, where the only requirement is displaying an American flag; to West Virginia, where reporters found a way to bypass building health and safety requirements by registering a “microschool” instead.

In Arkansas, all it took was a few clicks on the Arkansas secretary of state website, $45 and an American flag to form a bona fide private school with the Arkansas Times.

We established a school with Mountain State Spotlight in West Virginia after filing our new school’s name and location with authorities on a piece of notebook paper, then exchanging a few emails.

And with The Assembly in North Carolina, we filed an online notice of intent to open a private school at Ponysaurus Brewing Co. in Durham, while perched on its metal bar stools, eyeing glasses of a crisp kolsch.

NAUTILUS

The Key to Multilingualism Lies in the Ears, Not the Mouth

KRISTEN FRENCH · NAUTIL.US · OCT 13, 2026

Explains why listening, not accent practice, is the real bottleneck to sounding fluent.

Steve Martin’s favorite comic moment of his entire career is the “hamburger” scene from The Pink Panther (2006), he once told People magazine. Martin plays Inspector Clouseau, who has an aggressively exaggerated French accent. In the scene, he is trying to learn how to say, “I would like to buy a hamburger,” with a dialect coach. “Dam-buergaaaaa,” he purrs at his coach, along with increasingly ridiculous permutations of all of the other words in the sentence.

The scene is funny because it’s true for so many of us: Learning a new language as an adult can be hard. The unfamiliar sounds may get tangled up in the mouth like marbles, and the results can sound like gibberish. But for other people, new foreign words seem to roll off the tongue and adopting different accents comes easily. Their secret may lie in how they listen, according to a new study in the Journal of Experimental Psychology. People who are better at detecting small differences in the frequency of raw sound are better at picking up new foreign speech sounds, and thus might be quicker to learn new languages, the study found.

“Read more: Speaking More Languages May Help Slow Brain Aging”

“Most people approach foreign language learning by memorizing vocabulary and listening to speech, but our study indicated that language learners might also benefit from training the auditory abilities that underpin language learning itself,” said study author Kazuya Sait-van Poeteren of the UCL Institute of Education in London, in a statement. “Foreign language education should move beyond an approach based on ‘more practice’ and towards one that develops learners’ ear for language learning in line with their auditory characteristics.”

Continued online (full article about 794 words). Scan, or visit https://nautil.us/the-key-to-multilingualism-lies-in-the-ears-not-the-mouth-1285745/

NAUTILUS

Was Human Language Born Around the Campfire?

OLIVIA FERRARI · NAUTIL.US · OCT 14, 2026

Ties the origin of speech to early humans telling stories around fires.

We gather around campfires and share stories, keeping the darkness at bay to draw each other into worlds of ghosts and monsters, to immerse ourselves in the past and future. Communing around a fire entwines humanity in a yarn stretching back to our hominin ancestors, who stoked these embers of storytelling. And those nightly fires could have been the hearths from which early language emerged.

Hominins began taming fire around 1.5 million years ago, and by 400,000 years ago hearths were more common as our ancestors used fire to chase away darkness at night. The glowing little world that a fire creates around itself, painting cave walls and the faces of our companions in warm hues and lively shadows, calls us in to lean closely and listen. This environment may have ignited a shift from our ancestors communicating about the world around them, to narrating things they could not see. Communication moved from something like the gestures great apes use today, like chest-beating or baring their teeth, toward a simple proto-language that was a step toward modern language, according to an anthropologist and a primatologist who published their theory last month.

“Storytelling really is core to human evolution,” said Robin Dunbar, an emeritus professor of evolutionary psychology at the University of Oxford, who was not involved in the new study but who studies the behavioral, cognitive, and neuroendocrinological mechanisms that underpin social bonding in primates and early humans.

While we can’t know for sure what tales were told around crackling fires hundreds of thousands of years ago, modern day hunter-gatherer communities can illuminate what those ancient nights may have looked like. Anthropologist Pauline Wiessner worked for decades in Namibia and Botswana among Ju/’hoansi communities, whose nighttime conversations differ dramatically from daytime exchanges.

Continued online (full article about 1578 words). Scan, or visit https://nautil.us/was-human-language-born-around-the-campfire-1285790/

LONGREADS

The Kids Who Identify as Animals

CHERI LUCAS ROWLANDS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 14, 2026

A reported look at a rising subculture of children who say they don't feel entirely human.

For Boston Magazine, Kara Baskin explores a growing subculture of tweens and teens who don’t feel entirely human. Some identify as one animal, like a cat or a dog; others identify with multiple animals. One kid Baskin speaks to, Sol, says she “doesn’t summon the animals, but rather they come and go on their own schedule.” These young people call themselves therians (distinct from furries, who are fans of anthropomorphic animal characters). Baskin provides a fascinating glimpse into a world where adolescents can express themselves and explore their identities.

Bafflement is the baseline condition of raising kids right now. The adolescent quest for self-discovery is timeless—but today’s parents experimented in ways that were analog: new hairstyles, inscrutable music, beer snuck in the woods. Their own parents might not have liked it, but they could at least relate.

Now the landscape of adolescent discovery is literally foreign, thanks to social media, which has turbocharged once-obscure subcultures like the furry fandom—and, at its rarer edge, therianthropy—and redefined what “fringe” even means. Even if a kid is the only therian at school, she can find 400 more people just like her online. That’s one of the biggest challenges for parents in the algorithm age: The world your kid actually lives in is one you can’t enter. It touches the fear in every parent, therian kid or not: What happens when our kids inhabit a world we don’t understand, with idols we don’t recognize?

NAUTILUS

Leap Seconds Have Helped Keep Clocks Synchronized with Earth's Rotation, But Their Time May Be Over

VAHE PEROOMIAN · NAUTIL.US · OCT 13, 2026

The decades-long fix for Earth's wobbly rotation may be retired.

You’re probably used to the month of February having an extra day every four years, during the leap year. Timekeepers added that extra leap day because Earth completes one orbit around the Sun in about 365 and one-quarter days. If we didn’t add leap days, the equinoxes and solstices that mark the beginning of seasons would occur later, slowly shifting the days on which each season began.

For millennia, a day has been defined as one full rotation of the Earth. But the Earth’s rotation isn’t completely uniform, and in order to be more precise, modern timekeeping systems have stopped using the Earth’s rotation as their basis.

This switch created a discrepancy between how a single second used to be defined, and how it is defined today.

Continued online (full article about 1516 words). Scan, or visit https://nautil.us/leap-seconds-have-helped-keep-clocks-synchronized-with-earths-rotation-but-their-time-may-be-over-1285748/